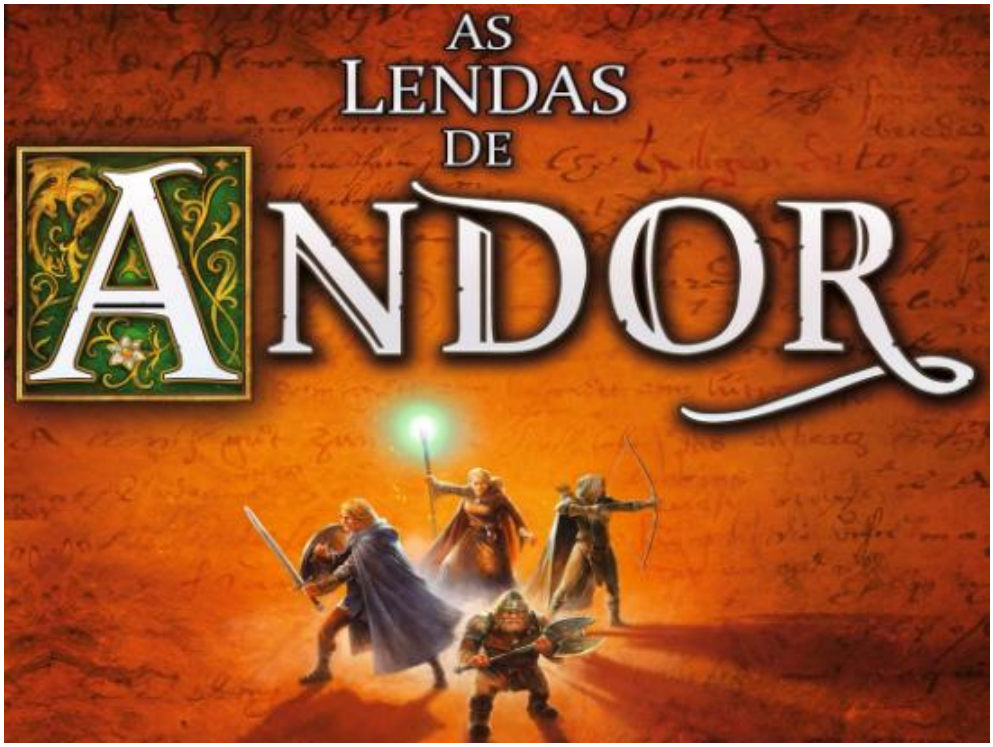
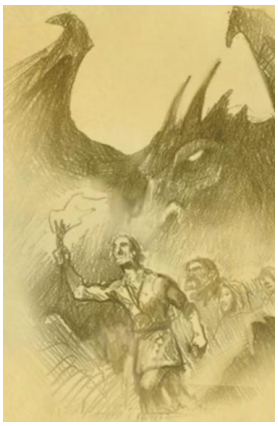






THE HISTORY

A small band of non-free flees from cruel rulers in an empty land. On the way there they have to pass the Gray Mountains and are almost destroyed by a dragon. But their leader, Brandur, faces the dragon with such willpower and determination that the dragon begins to fear for his immortal life. He lets the crowd pass and has since sent his creatures to kill Brandur.
The game "The Legends of Andor" begins about 80 years later. Brandur became the king of the small people and the country got the name "Andor" ...



THE CREATURES



Tarok and the creatures
Krahal, the magical place that gave the dragon power and energy, was deeply shaken hundreds of years ago. The dragons died and only one of them survived. From the depths of Krahal crawled creatures, unspeakable creatures with destructive powers. At some point, they left Krahal and scrambled in the mountains and forests of Andor to fight and kill for the last dragon.

They were Gors, evil creatures that dreaded humans and dwarves alike. Her arms and legs were dotted with scales. Her hands were two huge, pointed and sharp horn claws. Bent and submissive was her posture and they seemed to be waiting without understanding for the orders of the dragons.

There were other creatures, Skrale and Wardraks. Skrale were very tall and muscular. They carried huge swords in their hands. On arms and legs, their bodies were covered with armor pieces to protect them in combat. They were dangerous, because they made their own decisions and could win a fight with reason.
Echo-like, tall and fast were the Wardraks. Her eyes glowed like coals, vicious and mean. They were fast as arrows and could jump up the sharpest rocks and kill with their sharp claws, which got in their way.

Her master, the dragon who survived, was named Tarok. A huge creature. Monstrous, razor-sharp scales covered the gigantic body. Giant wings protruded from the plucking and the head sat on a snakelike neck. Blood red and mean, his eyes stared. There was no one who did not fear Tarok, and for centuries he was in the Gray

Mountains and made it impossible to cross the mountains. Brandur, however, faced the dragon. His willpower and determination made the dragon fear for its immortal life. He let Brandur and his friends pass and since then sent out his creatures to kill him. Years later, when Tarok attacked the Rietburg, it was only the heroes of Andor who opposed him.

REKA THE WITCH



One day Sabin found a child at the well. It was very early in the morning and the child was wrapped in white cloths and slept soundly. Sabin picked up the child and brought it to the Krahdern, which should determine what happened to the child. In the city the power lay with the Krahdern and Sabin belonged to the Ambacus, the unfree of the country. Radak, head of Krahd, decided that the child should stay with Sabin until it was old enough to serve the Krahdern. So she took the child, a girl and gave her the name Reka. Reka was a bright and inquisitive child and Sabin had a hard time with her. But Reka made life easier for Sabin, because Reka always managed to give Sabin strength for everyday life through something. Sometimes she just took her hand and looked at her and it seemed like she was breathing new powers. Sabin never knew what it was, but she feared that this gift would be known to the Krahdern.
The older Reka became the better she could use her skills. She helped a lot of Ambacus in distress, but no one knew exactly what that help was, but anyone who got it could say, "I'm feeling better now." Reka became a strong young woman trying to escape at the side decided by Brandur. Her strength helped her escape and many years later she was indispensable to the heroes of Andor.

THE TROLLS



The trolls have always lived in Andor. They were gigantic and simple creatures with enormous power. They killed arbitrarily and tortured humans and animals. Long before Brandur and his friends reached Andor, the keepers of the watchful forest and the trolls fought inexorably.
Troll's arms and legs were huge muscles, and her upper body seemed to tower over everything else. Weapons they did not carry with them, but took in the fight, what appeared to them big enough, tree trunks or rocks. Smaller objects could not reach them with their huge paws. They also influenced the fate of Andor. Twenty years before the game "The Legends of Andor" begins the last great battle takes place on the summer rock. This battle ended the troll wars and since then there are very few of them.

OUTLOOK

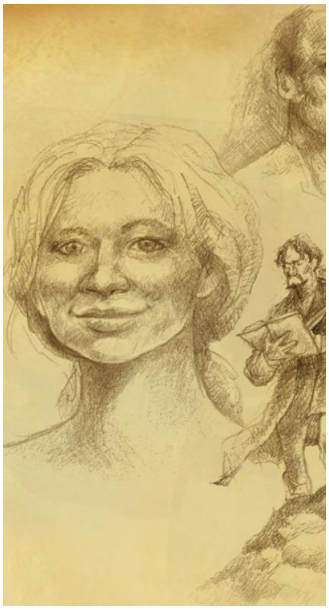


The legends of andor - what happened next ...

After Tarok defeated the dragon, troubled times ensued, reports of which entered the archives of the Tree of Songs as "The Legacy of the Dragon."

The creatures were out of whack. They came from afar and ventured to Andor. Soon the heroes realized that the fear of Tarok had kept many evil creatures away from Andor. After the fall of the dragon, Varkur, the Dark Magician, returned. His transformation was dramatic and he was more dangerous than ever. His desire for power became the greatest danger to Andor. But there were also bright spots. With the disappearance of the dragon, commerce flourished, the art of cartography and also the builders of the country had their hands full. Years passed before the heroes responded to a call for help from far-off Hadria and began the dangerous voyage to the north. There they experienced another great adventure.

KEN DORR, MERRIK AND GILDA



Ken Dorr, the thief

Ken Dorr was a descendant of the first Andori, who escaped from Krahd together with Brandur. In the troll wars, his parents' farm was completely destroyed and his family was left with nothing. In order to survive they relied on the charity of others. For Ken Dorr, this was a serious blow because he was a proud boy and despised having to live on the alms of others. So he started stealing to take care of his family. Later, he was received as a soldier in the service of King Brandur and proved a skilled swordsman. His preference for stealing, however, he did not put off. After spending some time at the castle, he was discovered stealing and banished from the castle. At that time, exile from the castle was a death sentence. Before he left the castle, he still took what he needed to survive. Through his fighting skills Ken Dorr made it to the coast of Andor. There he smuggled himself aboard a merchant ship to leave Andor and start a new life. From then on, little is known about his life, but when the rumor went around, the terror of Andor, the dragon Tarok was finally defeated, he returned to Andor and again caused mischief.

Merrik, the cartographer

Born in the Woods, Merrik studied the art of calligraphy and archiving from childhood. He proved to be a skilled bookbinder and decorated his scrolls with fine drawings. But he was filled with a constant restlessness. He was not made to write down the adventures and legends of others - he wanted to experience them himself. As a 12-year-old boy, he was allowed to accompany Melkart the supreme keeper and some other keepers on a trip to Rietburg and was fascinated by the great defenses. When they were ambushed on the way back, he barely survived because he was of a feeble build and barely able to carry a wooden sign. But even if he was not a fighter or archer, his thirst for adventure was unbroken. Soon he began to draw the path between castle and forest and tried to learn from written records more about the geography of the country Andor.

Merrik's drive was unfulfilled and finally, at the age of 16, he was allowed to walk. He visited the Rietburg again, moved south through the Rietland and explored the Southern Forest. When he returned to the tree of songs about a year later, he looked many years older. In his luggage he had the most detailed map you have ever seen. The value of these maps was hardly high enough to estimate, because many there marked ways or sources were only the fewest known.

Merrik spent many years studying Andor's cartography and is said to have even charted the southern foothills of the Gray Mountains and was the first person in years to ever see the land of the Krahders with his own eyes. He had often been in dangerous situations during all his walks. And because he himself was not a good fighter, he soon concluded an agreement with a young wolf warrior named Orfen. This accompanied him frequently and kept him all sorts of evil creatures from the body. In later years, Merrik made a name for himself above all with his nautical charts from the Hadrian Sea.

Gilda, the innkeeper of the tavern

Gilda's father was a Keeper of the Watchful Forest. His name was Kallun and he was on an important assignment to Rietburg. At the request of King Brandur Kallun should teach him reading and writing. Although the king was a clever mind, he had received no education as a slave in Krahd. Gilda's mother was Bertha and met Kallun in the tavern of Andor. Bertha instantly fell in love with him. When Kallun talked to the other tavern guests, he was amazed how many stories and legends the men and women of old days knew and he listened eagerly. At first he hardly noticed Bertha until she herself recounted a particularly rude and funny ballad about the "drunken troll". Bertha was spirited and funny and the ballad ended in loud cheers and applause. A lot of mead filled the pitchers before the next morning dawned. Kallun promised to return when he left. He never did, and nine months later Gilda was born. She spent her childhood in the tavern and had inherited her mother's serene mind. Gilda had a beautiful voice and guests often came from far away just to hear her sing. In later years she preferred to listen to the guests rather than to sing, for there was much happening in the land of Andor, and many legends were given to her. In a way, she too, like her father Kallun, had become a Keeper, though she never wrote down the legends, but always kept them in her head.

Years later, when the heroes of Andor were searching for the Star Shield, there were those who believed that it had been Gilda who had given them the crucial clue to finding the Star Shield.

THE TAVERN TO THE DRUNKEN TROLL



Not so long ago, the landlady Gilda told of her grandfather's story:
At that time grandfather Erloth had a wooden cart with which he sold mead and wine to the surrounding farms. With a particularly large load he rumbled towards the market bridge to delight the dwarves with his goods. But on his way the unbelievable happened: He was attacked by a giant troll! Fortunately, grandfather was able to escape unseen in the high reef grass. But the troll destroyed his car and made his way over the barrels. It seemed to taste good, for when Erloth came back to see if there was anything left to save, he saw a huge figure stagger away, which was not surprising, for he had almost drained the entire supply of mead and wine. This was followed by some amusing incidents with Andor peasants! Instead of chasing and eating them, the troll lurched past them singing or sleeping in their stables.
However, the cart was destroyed and so Grandfather decided to build a small stand out of the ruptured parts and sell the remains of mead and wine from the place of the raid. The stand soon became a small hut. Many travelers came and told what happened here and there in the country. And so, from the remains of the old cart, the tavern became the drunken troll and I, Gilda, the granddaughter of Erloth, became after my mother, the landlady.

VARA, THE WATER SPIRIT



Kheela, the guardian of the River Lands and Janis, her son stood on the bank of the Narne. Dusk had fallen and it was getting cold. Janis pointed his finger to the other shore, where the silhouette of a woman was to see and asked: "Mother, what is she actually?"
Kheela looked up and said, "That's a long story, and when you're old enough, I'll tell you."
"Mother, please, I'm eight already." Kheela smiled at her son. "You may be right. I was seven when my dad spoke about her for the first time. Alright then sit down and listen carefully.
"Her name is Vara. Many hundred years ago she lived, like all water spirits here in the river. "
Janis's eyes widened: "Is she that old?"
"Yes, she is very old and has done a lot for the people here."
"There are more who are like her?"
"Yes, but they live in this water. They are the soul of the river and keep it alive. Vara is not here voluntarily. She was banished by her people. "Kheela took a deep breath and then continued," Your great-great-great-grandfather was a simple farmer named Etore. He ordered his fields and cared for his parents and siblings. But that was not all, he also cared for those who needed help. He was young and strong and wherever he was in trouble he came and offered his help.
One day something terrible happened. A big fire had broken out in the village. People tried by all means to extinguish the flames. With big buckets they dragged water from the river to the village. Etore was among them.

The water spirits watched the goings-on of the people and then Vara saw him for the first time. He had severe burn injuries, but he kept running into the village with a full bucket, ignoring his pain. Many people died that night and the village burned down completely.
From now on, Vara watched the brave Etore and fell in love with him. It was a foolish love, but love is foolish at times, and Vara did something that had not been ventured into before. She got out of her element and followed her love. Etore was startled by the sight of her, for she was a figure of water without firm contours. She was beautiful, but also scary. Vara stayed with him for a while, helping wherever she could. But she soon realized that her love would be forever unrequited, because Etore married a woman. Vara left Etore and wanted to go back to the river, forgetting her grief and her sisters and brothers. But the water spirits denied her this wish and punished her for her stubbornness. She could never return home and was banished.

It took some time for Vara to go to Etore again. Her sadness startled the peasants and, with compassion, offered to continue to take care of the well-being of the people on the river. Vara accepted his offer and since this day she is here and fulfills this task. Etore became the first keeper of the River Lands and until today this task is passed on to the first offspring from his line. "
Kheela looked at her son.

Sadly, this Vara looked at the water spirit. "And she can never go back?"
"No, she can not do that. The love she once felt for Etore has turned into great grief. She is lonely, very lonely and yet for centuries she has supported the keeper of the river country and for that I am very grateful to her. One day you will take on this task and have it as a faithful companion by your side. She will carry on the legacy of Etore, the simple farmer. "
The water spirit came to them and gently brushed the boy's hand. A faint hint of summer dew formed where she had touched him and she disappeared.

THE TWO ORDERS



Far to the north of the Hadrischen sea lay the island Hadria. An inhospitable island surrounded by rough seas, whose steep, dark cliffs projected into the sea. The forces of the sea brought storms that icy gnawed at the rocks, snow that spread over the land and winds whose strength tore everything away. Farther south were the Misty Islands and Cliffwatch, a castle built on a single, large rock. Varatan, the sea king, lived there.

Life in Hadria was arduous, winter unbearable and people often suffered from hunger. In some years, when the weather was a bit milder, barley and wheat could be grown, but too often the cold season came early and rain and frost destroyed the plants. These times could only be overcome by livestock, because the animals gave milk and eggs, but often they had to be slaughtered in bad times.

On this island lived the wizards of the Yra feasts. They were friars dedicated to making life more bearable for the people of Hadria. They were scholars and passed on their knowledge for generations. But each of them knew that the help they could give was enough only until winter came back and took the people they had worked for.

One day, the most inquisitive of them left the path of sorcery, which directs and intensifies the inner power of every thing and living thing. They began to impose their will on things, transform them and create them anew. They alienated their true meaning and purpose. They discovered the dark magic.

Among them was Orweyn, the most powerful of all sorcerers. He was inspired by the idea of freeing the country from the winter and taming the powers of the sea. Arcturus, the Lord of the Storms, Kenvilar, the Treacherous and Octohan, the Master of the Deep, should bow to his will.

He was gathering like-minded people and spending many years exploring dark magic. In the nights that Orweyn bowed over the writings, he devised a plan.

Magic weapons should be forged that enable a person to rebel against the forces of the sea and defeat them. But who would dare to do such a daring venture? Orweyn himself was eager to learn, but not a martial warrior.

But one day fate should bring him this warrior. A large ship reached the coast of Hadria. It was the Tambur and her captain was the proud King of the Sea Varatan. His coming triggered a tumult as he brought along wheat, rye and other foods. Barrels of wine and goat cheese from Storm Valley, and even apple nuts and mushrooms from the distant Dragonland, later to become known as the land of Andor.

When Orweyn heard of his arrival, he believed in a happy coincidence.

This Sea King, whose name meant fire son, seemed the right person for his plans. He invited him in and it soon became clear how right Orweyn was. Varatan told of his trip across the Hadrian Sea, the dangers he had defied, and how much he wished that winter would finally be over. After eating and drinking warm mead, Orweyn began telling of his plan to defeat the forces of the sea and banish the winter forever. Varatan's eyes lit up as he heard of the magic weapons Orweyn wanted to forge.

That night should be the fate of Hadria turn.

And so the friars of the blacksmith started their dark work. As they worked, gray mist wafted over the fire, threatening mischief.

They created Varlion the Flaming Sword, a heavy two-handed sword blazing flames on the blade that only extinguished when pushed into the scabbard. Orweyn's hammer, which he held in his own pocket and which strengthened his wearer more and more with each fight. And finally, Varatan's helmet designed to protect the king from the forces of the sea.

After they were finished, a message was sent to the Sea King. He had returned to Klippenwacht and meanwhile started a fleet with the construction and manned them with good sailors from Klippenwacht and the other fog islands.

When he reached Hadria, Orweyn handed over the magic weapons and watched proudly, but with bated hearts, as Varatan Hadria left.

For a long time, the magician remained uncertain about the whereabouts of the Sea King. As he did so, he became more involved with Dark Magic and the more he understood Dark Magic, the more his doubts became. He sensed that she was taking her toll.

After many months, a terrible storm swept over Hadria. And in that thunderous storm, Varatan suddenly appeared. His fleet was destroyed. He had lost them in the fight against the powers of the sea and to punish him for his presumption, they also destroyed the great castle Klippenwacht. Now they approached Hadria.

Charged, the Sea King called on the friars to strike back. Arkteron, Kenvilar and Oktohan were to be wiped out, but Orweyn refused. He had finally fully understood what dark magic was doing. She always demanded more than she gave and that had to end.

Instead, he ordered the construction of the Iron Tower. There should be included the magic weapons and the acquired dark knowledge about magic.

After the tower had been completed, Orweyn asked the friars to follow him to the tower, because their knowledge must be closed to protect the people of Hadria. Only then could the powers of the sea be soothed.

He ordered the youngest sorcerers to lock him and his brothers in the tower. Orweyn prevailed against the protests of King Varatan and his friars. He killed some of them by hand to erase their knowledge from the world. The fear of the powers of the sea had broken his mind. He talked confused and before he was the last to enter the tower, he prophesied the end of Hadriah if the wizards ever disagreed and summoned them together. Then he went into the Iron Tower and the gate was closed behind him and all magical knowledge. Orweyn and his brothers were never seen again.

But his victim had not missed its effect. The storm subsided, the powers of the sea were reconciled and sank back into the depths. Only the cold and the winter stayed and should not give way anymore.

The young and far less skilled wizards stayed behind and from then on called themselves the wizards of the Iron Tower.

The Sea King stayed in Hadria. He joined the remaining wizards of Hadria and learned what they could teach. Apparently, Varatan gave up all royal dignity and became one of them, but he quarreled with Orweyn's decision to surrender to the powers of the sea, leaving Hadria and the sea to the Eternal Winter.

He moved to Nordgard, the capital of Hadrias. There, according to legend, he nagged other dissatisfied wizards around him. It turned out that many of them had retained some magical knowledge, but Orweyn's eyes had escaped and not been locked in the Iron Tower.

Varatan found a wife in Hadria and she soon gave him a son named Varkmar, which meant as much as a sea of flames.

He grew up with a desire for power and the knowledge hidden in the Iron Tower.

In later years, after Varkmar had learned all that remained of magical knowledge, his father died. Nevertheless, his thirst for knowledge remained and he founded a new Order of Wizards: The Wizards of Fire. Those wizards

who did not want to put up with the Eternal Winter, who over the years demanded more and more the opening of the Iron Tower to liberate the magic.

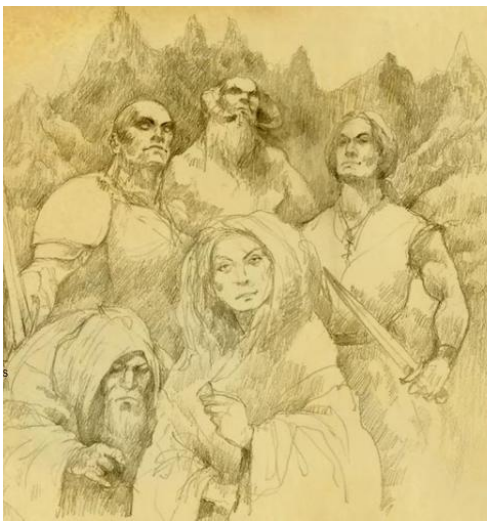
In the long, cold years, the wizards of the tower and sorcerers of the fire continued to separate. Dark magic stood between them and Varkmar stirred their hatred.

But when he had reached the zenith of his power, he sensed that he would never have the power to take the Iron Tower to liberate the magic. During this time, his wife gave birth to a son. On the night of his birth, the eternal fires shone brightly, but over the island of Hadria a huge storm raged. Full of pride Varkmar looked at his powerful son, in whose eyes a magical fire burned at birth. He hoped his son would fulfill Varatan's legacy and accomplish what he had never done:

Unleash the magic and destroy and burn the hated wizards of the Iron Tower. And so he gave his son the name Varkur: The Flame.

But its story is told in another legend ...

VARATAN'S CURSE



"Pah, sailor's yarn!" King Varatan always said when someone told him about the three powers of the sea. He said this until the day he came across the most dangerous of them: Kenvilar, the treacherous ones.
Although the mighty Octohan would bring a ship with its tentacles to burst and Arcteron dreaded storms, Kenvilar was the most fatal of them. Their problem was coupled with cruel wisdom.

One day, as she lay in wait for the king's ship and dragged several sailors into the depths, she noticed a Varatanian at the helm of the two-master. He stood tall and strong. The crew tried to master the danger with harpoons and sea swords, but Kenvilar hardly noticed them.
She caught the young helmsman's eye, looked into his future, saw his potential and the sleeping malice in him. Kevilar sensed that she could do much more damage with a little patience. And so she retired.

The king celebrated his supposed victory over one of the three powers of the sea with everything that belonged to it. The survivors were honored and the dead were thought. Wine was drunk and lavishly fed. The festival was remembered for a long time.
Years passed before the paths of the helmsman and Kenvilar crossed again. The name of the man was Callem. He had meanwhile received command of his own ship and sailed between Varatania or Werft home, as it was later called, and Klippenwacht, the maritime stronghold of King Varatan.

On one of these trips, he left his route for no apparent reason and soon found himself in stormy waters again. Kenvilar showed up there and the former helmsman fell under his spell ...

The ship and its crew were soon lost and mourned with all imaginable honors. Callem, her captain, had been a well-known naval warrior and his death meant a heavy loss to the king.

It was the time when Varatan began to ponder how to master the powers of the sea. A little later, his path would lead him to the north, to Hadria in the land of sorcery, where he was to develop magical weapons with Orweyn, the most powerful sorcerer.

But before all this happened, rumors started about a black ship. It came out of nowhere and vanished in the same way! Merchant ships were attacked and robbed of their goods. Here and there the black ship was spotted and its crew ... it was the strangest thing, because on board were not just simple sailors and apostate sea warriors. Among them were sorcerers and wizards, druids and other powerful beings. Therefore, it was not possible for a long time to get to the black cog, as the ship was now called everywhere.

After his alleged death Callem had destroyed his ship, because Kenvilar had given him a much larger and stronger as a gift. He killed most of his team with his own hands. It was a bloodbath. Roa, the huge bird of prey, with claws, pointed and sharp like a sword and with his red shimmering plumage, helped him. Only Pero, his first Mart and Krumm, an old, bowed man whom they were supposed to bring to Varatania, remained alive.

The old crook claimed to be a sorcerer and brewed a potion to prove that he dipped the ship in thick fog. Callem found it useful. In his cabin, the captain of the ship found a green-skinned girl with devious eyes. Another gift Kenvilars, because it was Kentar, her daughter. The ship was to become her new home.
And so they set sail and with almost every one of their raids the crew grew. During a raid near Stormtal, Thogger, a Druid of the Tars joined. His potions gave all crewmembers great powers and the ability to breathe underwater.

In another raid, you captured Ean Quella. A student from Hadria who wanted to complete her training as a sorceress while traveling. For a long time she resisted Callem's influence. Eventually Kentar, Kenvilar's daughter, managed to poison her mind. And so she put her skills in the service of the captain.

Callem sought the crown of the northern seas, and his power grew steadily. At some point the threat of the Black Congue became so great that King Varatan rested his fight against the forces of the sea and set out in search of the Black Cog.
Finding the hated ship and cornering it required the king's entire naval fleet. At a tremendous speed, which could not be attributed solely to the wind, the Black Cog evidently fled westward. Hoping to catch up with them, King Varatan and his fleet pursued the ship, when suddenly, out of nowhere, the coast of an unknown land loomed before them. A mist island whose existence had been unknown to the king until then. This must have been the secret hideout from where the Black Cog had started their raids. The gray sail of the cog was reefed and let boats into the water at lightning speed. The crew fled to the mist island. The king did not think long and took up the chase. When they reached the island, the sea warriors stormed Varatans, killing anyone they could get hold of.

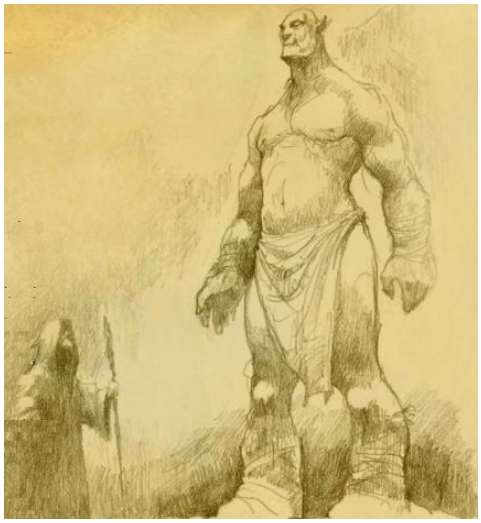
Steep mountain ranges towered before them, and when the king reached the first peak, his breath caught. Behind the mountains lay a dark, sick forest. His smell of decay struck him from afar. He suddenly recognized sinister lizard-like creatures crawling out of rocky outcroppings. They were Gors or maybe worse. This land was a bad place and a deadly trap. A trap he was not allowed to touch. In his mind he baptized the island in the name of Narkon, for that was how the Varatanians called a trap or an ambush, and he ordered his sea-warriors retreat. Some did not hear his call and continued the persecution. Among those who fought most eagerly behind the refugees was also his old Kamarad Ruuf. A good man. 'Be that as it may,' thought the king, 'I too can not help him'.
There was more at stake here than the lives of a few. And so King Varatan, ruler of the North Sea, spread his arms and swore a curse upon the land north of the mountain. Let the creatures and apostates never leave this island again and starve forever in suffering and misery. He cursed the land of Narkon and retired with his own.

Callem, however, who had hidden within earshot of the king, immediately sensed a change in mind and body. Fear and anger flowed through him. Then he suddenly saw a ghostly figure of light, placing a gleaming hand on his shoulder. All at once he forgot the sea and the ships and on all the memories that lay far away from this island, the black shadow of forgetfulness lay down. Every thought of flight requires a perception of another place, or at least the hope of the existence of a place other than the here. But all those who succumbed to the curse were forever robbed of this idea.

More than a hundred years passed. Years in which the magic weapons in Hadria were forged and closed again, because their power was too great and too dangerous. Years in which Varatan died and a young wizard named Varkur, who came from Varatan's line, saw the light of day to cause great evil. Years when a slave from southern Krahd fled into the land of the dragon, defeated him and then founded the land called Andor. Years when a small group of heroes became legendary and two of them stranded on the cursed island of Narkon.

Chada and Thorn. Will you meet Callem and the cursed Black Cog crew? Will they succumb to Varatan's curse and never leave the island?

THE GIFT OF THE MAGICIAN



This story happened around the same time as the Heroes of Andor denied the Battle of Cavern. It is anticipated that this attack of the creatures on the realm of the shield gnomes was no coincidence, but the first step of a grand plan ...

Spoiler warning for those who have not yet played "The Journey to the North".

Prince Undavahr stared into the evening sky. Cloud-covered and murky, he lay like lead over Borghorn, the great festival of the Krahders. Undavahr felt the omnipresent emptiness. His massive gray body lay on a stone block in the middle of his tower room. The stink of filth and rotting meals was heavy in the air.
Suddenly Undavahr heard several voices shouting. His lame mind took a while to realize that there was actually shouting, even shouting, in the courtyard. Any excitement had been so long ago that he did not even know how it felt. His heart began to pump more vigorously and he got up clumsily. Then it occurred to him in a flash that perhaps there had been an escape attempt. It was very rare, but every now and then one of the slaves believed he could escape the festival. It was, of course, pure superstition. Only a few tried and no one succeeded. Well, almost nobody. Years ago, a small group had made it. This sting was still sitting deep in the flesh of his house. Never again would they allow slaves to escape!

The prince trotted down the hewn stone steps of his tower. The voices, now more shouting, came from the west wing and he quickened his pace. On his way, some skeleton guards overtook him. "Damn," he thought now completely awake, "I'm fat and lame. The skeletons will still take all the fun! "But no sooner had he thought that and filled his lungs to call back his servants, there was a glaring light in his eyes. Shortly thereafter, it clattered and a mess of bones and lances whirred through the air. Undavahr stopped in alarm. What was going on here? An outbreak? A rebellion? He suddenly realized that he had not even bothered to take his sword or his armor with him. He would have strangled a fleeing slave with his bare hands, but what was this ...? A cloud of dust was in the air and Undavahr could not see anything specific.
An iron grip gripped his shoulder and he spun around. It was one of the Krahder warriors who served his father. "You should go to safety, my prince," he called to him. Then it continued on its way and disappeared almost entirely in the dust cloud. Undavahr thought he recognized the silhouette of a small figure. He heard the voice of the warrior, which soon grew louder. "Not one step further," Undavahr could hear, and then he saw his companion swinging out his sword. Undavahr looked excited as the blade fell on the small figure. At the last moment, she yanked up a kind of staff and parried the slash. And now, a moment later, it seemed as if the gunman had dropped his sword, folded his arms behind his back, and bowed. Could it be? Undavahr could not see it in all the dust, no, it was not dust anymore. A kind of thick black mist had spread and looped around the warrior's body. Like black ropes, the mist around the Krahder began to scream. With a dry crack, like breaking a branch, the warrior collapsed. The mist released the dead Krahder and wrapped itself around the figure, who, dressed in cloak and hood, slowly moved towards Undavahr. Undavahr's eyes widened, unable to fight, scream, or run away.
"This, my friend," whispered the stranger as he approached Undavahr, "what you are feeling right now is called fear. You have not been afraid for too long, I think. I can change that. "
Undavahr stammered something, he did not know what.
"Take me to your master. Take me to the king of slavers. I have a gift for him. "

Even though Undavahr could never remember what happened afterwards, it must have been that he had led the stranger to the throne room of King Gonhar, his father. His memory did not recur until he saw the hundred and more skeleton soldiers with their swords and lances, all standing in a large semicircle around him and the man in the gray cloak. He also recognized some of his family. Ennevahr, his sister. Corion, whom everyone called the whip, Tuavahr, the master of the dead, and Cuhor the sorcerer.
The room trembled with tension and Undavahr, gradually clearing again, shook itself and pressed itself between the other Krahders. Everyone looked anxiously between the stranger and Gonhar, the king back and forth. Gonhar was also incredibly tall for a krahder and his throne was a massive gray rock, polished through the many years that Gonhar and his ancestors had spent on it.

"Now stranger. What words are you the last to give of yourself? "Gonhar's voice boomed. "What do you want to say before we grab you and leave you to the slow death of fire."
The stranger was silent as if he were thinking about his last words. But instead of the stranger it burst out of Undavahr: "He has a gift, O King". Cursed! Undavahr had not wanted to say that. What did this person do to him?
Gonhar raised a brow and then the stranger spoke. Undavahr heard his words very clearly, though he gave little more than a whisper.
"I know who you are. I know your story, O Gonhar. Far to the north there is a tree. A tree where people keep time, history. They preserve the events, their knowledge and their legends. You too can be found there, curled up on brittle sheets of parchment right next to a text about forest mushrooms and herbs of doubtful potency. For a long time I studied there, unseen, undetected in secret. I've been looking for you in those dusty shelves and leather books and I've found you. "Slowly he raised his head and Undavahr craned his neck to see better and finally he could see under the hood a lizard-like face with a dense black beard. "Your worst outrages are recorded there in beautiful manuscripts. But do not worry. I like bad deeds! "A big smile appeared on his face.
"My name is Varkur and I actually have a gift for you. It's called Andor. "

Gonhar cleared the hall. Only he. His son Undavahr and the stranger stayed behind. He went on to tell of the land of Andor and the people who lived there, who had once been Gonhar's slaves. He revealed that they were ruled by a king named Thorald, who was only a pale shadow of his father. And, of course, he talked about the heroes and the shield gnomes he had recently engaged in a great battle. For the creatures had caved in Cavern at his command to weaken the dwarfs and give him the opportunity to come here unnoticed. After Varkur's remarks there was silence in the hall and Undavahr could not predict how his father would react.

"This land, Andor, as you call it, has always been inhabited by a dragon," the king said slowly.
"He was defeated by the very same hero I've told you about, High King," Varkur replied.
"We are to come to a land where there are heroes who can kill a dragon? Why should we do that if they have such power? ".
"Father's cracked," thought Undavahr. "Almost as smart as a coward."
"For two reasons, you should take this land, the first of which is far more important, Your Highness," said Varkur solemnly, then turned to Undavahr. "I see that your son has inherited the noble appearance of his father. If I'm not mistaken, I've seen such a face before. He was a stately Krahder and a brave warrior. "
"Who do you call mages," Undavahr said.
"From the secondborn son of your father. From your brother. Ferntahr, was his name, if I remember correctly, right? "

Ferntahr, Undavahr's brother had been on the move a few years ago. The same void had plagued him as Undavahr, but as a second-born he could not even hope to become king someday. Eventually, the Unrast had gained the upper hand and Ferntahr had set out to explore the Gray Mountains. He wanted to find new slaves or treasures, he said on his departure.

"What do you know about Ferntahr?" Undavahr exclaimed.
"Oh, it hurts me to bring you the bad news. But he was also a victim of the heroes of Andor. It happened in the era of Star Shield, where they also fought me. In the back they lured your brother into a trap, as soon as he set foot in their land. "
Undavahr screamed and knocked over a nearby table that flew several yards through the hall. Immediately some Krahders and fifty or more skeletons stormed into the hall. But Gonhar ended the turmoil and soon silence came again. Then he turned back to Varkur.

"Good magician. You now have my full attention but know: I will not let myself become a pawn in your ranks. A present do you call that? This gift is poisoned. Wizards, shield gnomes, warriors and archers. My son Ferntahr has been trapped, but I will not make the same mistake. Now say, what is the second reason why I should leave my party and endanger myself? "
"I want to tell you. Once I return, I will see to it that these heroes leave the country defenseless. I myself will lure her to the North and to certain death. "
Gonhar's eyes narrowed. "And if you fail? If they defeat you again and return? "
"They will not. And if it does, well, that's why I'm here ... "Varkur cried solemnly. "Rip up your homeland and bring back your slaves. Fill your dungeons and mines with fresh blood! Destroy Andor! So I will prevail in defeat! "
King Gonhar frowned as Varkur's words echoed in the great hall.

When Varkur left Borghorn on the following day, Prince Undavar accompanied him to the big gate.
"Your father is a coward old fool!" Hissed Varkur. "He still is not sure if he should accept my gift. But you are carved of different wood, my prince. Do not let his sloth and cowardice stop your raid. Think of your brave brother. Avenge him and get back what's yours. "
Undavahr nodded slowly.
"One more thing," Varkur said as he walked. "In case I fail in the far north and the heroes return, I have to warn you. Among them is one that you truly must fear. I hope I can give her a very painful end myself. But if not, maybe one day it will be up to you to kill her. She listens to the name Chada. you must not underestimate her. Your will can break mountains. "

Varkur left Krahd and soon turned north. How his story went on is told in "The Journey to the North".

Undavahr stared into the evening sky. Cloudy and cloudy. Gray like lead. But instead of an emptiness he felt great excitement. With or without the permission of his father, he would soon arm his army and then make his way through the Gray Mountains at the head of many hundreds of skeleton soldiers. He would leave and get the magician's gift.

THE WINTER CASTLE



Prolog:

Our heroes had returned to devastated Andor and decided to take up the Krahder persecution. They did not want to leave the abducted Andori to the torture of slavery. Their path led through the gray mountains. Formerly a place where dwarven lords, giants, and dragons used to live, and in later times fought wars against each other. A history-laden no-man's-land, about which little is known and about which even in the tree of songs hardly anything is to be found. The history of Winterburg, however, is kept there, and although none of our heroes ever read it, you should now hear it ...

Once, when there were still large dwarf empires in the Gray Mountains, these not only built underground tunnels and halls. Here and there they struck unearthly towers and fortresses from the rock. They have always strived to be in harmony with the natural rock formations, like stone echoes of nature. Powerful statues of dragons and dwarves created them that still tower out of the fog like dumb watchmen.

The most beautiful and largest fortress was the castle Karulzar. Built on such a high ridge that she often wore snow hoods on her turrets for much of the summer. So she was soon known to all as the winter castle.

In her long history she had many owners. First, of course, there were the dwarves. But in the wars against the dragons and giants, they left their supernatural fortresses and retreated into the underground halls.

Dragons soon settled in the spacious towers and halls. However, only for a short time, because the giants had their eyes on the fortress. She was beautiful and strong. The Giants appreciated the craftsmanship of the dwarfs and the quality of their products, although they did not bother the dwarves themselves.

But the real reason for her interest in Winterburg was that she was too close to the borders of her own country to be left to an enemy like the Dragon. The dragons of that time were wise and powerful and far superior to the giants. A dangerous neighbor.

But there was one among the giants, even the dragons feared, because he was a sorcerer. Nomion he called himself. He was the first giant to explore witchcraft and discover its power over others. His abilities increased rapidly and soon he was able to brew potions for the Giant Warriors, who strengthened their will. He developed the gift to impose his will on other beings and to control them. And when he succeeded in resurrecting the dead bones of fallen giants, his witchcraft had completely changed the life of his people. From then on they called themselves the Krahders, the immortals. This was of course nonsense, because they died like all other beings when their time came. And what resurrected the dead was the power of Nomion. And yet it was the witchcraft that made her different from other giants and made her krahdern.

And Nomion passed on his knowledge, and his disciples built temples and planted the black tree to nourish and make omnipresent the evil witchcraft, like the air to breathe.

But Nomion was looking for more. He sought a deserted dwarf tower in the Gauen Mountains and spent a long time looking for the most powerful creature in the entire southern world. And when he found it, he enslaved his spirit and made it a subject.

Soon he let it attack the winter castle. Many young dragons died in this terrible attack, and the proud feasts of yesteryear burst under the blows of the incredible creature.

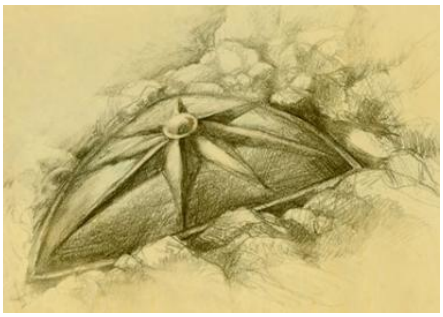
But Nomion also came to an end that day. The strongest and most cunning of all dragons, Tarok, found the sorcerer who commanded his creature in secret, not far from what had happened. Nomion was not a big fighter and his powerful servant was involved in the fight against the dragons at Winterburg. Tarok had no trouble destroying Nomion, leaving only a pile of ashes from the sorcerer.

The creature, later called the Urtroll, soon left the Winterburg and retreated to its stony sleep. Hardly a dragon had survived the attack and the festival was destroyed.

The few surviving dragons left the Winterburg, which now offered no more protection than any rock. But the ruin should not remain uninhabited for a long time. Something stirred in the gray ashes that had once been Nomion. A bluish glow blazed as a pale figure rose. For a long time, it was to haunt the abandoned fortresses and towers of the Gray Mountains. It was Nomion's mind.

Will his spirit still be there when you make your way to the Gray Mountains in the fall ...?

THE STAR SHIELD

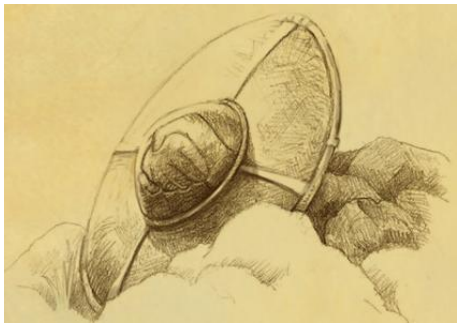


The Star Shield dates from a time when there was no hostility between shield gnomes and dragons. Once upon a time, before Krahall, the place that gave life to the dragon, was shaken, there was an alliance between dragons and the people of the dwarfs. It was that the dwarves dug shafts deep underground and huge halls used to house the dragon. In return, the dragons gave the dwarves the secrets of the fire, allowing them to drive away the eternal gloom under the mountains.
But one day the dwarves began to wrest new wonders from the fire. At first they began to forge beautiful vessels and lamps, and later chains and rings as edging for the gems of the deep. Then they came up with steel gates for their treasuries, and wrath overcame the dragons. As the dwarves forged weapons as sharp as dragon claws and armor hard as dragon scales, the rage of the dragons blazed up and the fret broke. An underground war broke out.

According to legend, there was a special time before anger and anger crept into the alliance. It was short-lived, but changed a lot. Kreatok, the dwarf was a gifted blacksmith, with a lot of curiosity and thirst for knowledge. He was assisted by Nehal, a young dragon, spirited and strong, but also willing to create something new. The Dwarf's skill and the dragon's fire created four mighty shields.

One of these shields was the Star Shield. He gave hope to his bearer, even if the situation seemed hopeless.

THE BROTHER SHIELD



The brother shield was one of the four mighty shields of ancient times. When dwarfs and dragons were still in friendship, Kreatok, the dwarf, and Nehal the dragon created this shield. According to legend, he had the power to transfer the power of one brother in arms to another. This was a powerful weapon, as Cavern's dwarf mines were big. The long distances became a problem, because even the best fighters could not be everywhere at the same time. When the heroes of Andor were reinforced by other fighters, such as the Taren Bragor or Kheela, the guardian of the river country, this shield was also found and was of great use to the heroes.

THE STORM SHIELD



Prince Hallwort, the maniac, stood in the midst of his armory and lived up to his recently acquired nickname. He laughed out loud as he saw his reflection in the sign in his hands, grotesquely elongated and grinning at him. His gray, long hair was tied in a shaggy plait and his blue eyes flashed with joy.

Actually, he had come to the armory to prepare himself, because tomorrow was to start his great journey. His followers had stared at him when, a few days ago, he told them about the trip and his decision to leave Cavern.

Since then much had happened. There had been a fight. Madness is this! A prince could not leave Cavern, cried his captains. This iron law could not be broken. But Hallwort, who until then had been nicknamed "the Great," had not been deterred.

Hallwort was known as a glorious fighter and powerful ruler, but his restlessness made him at times unruly and unjust. It was rumored that even his huge, underground realm was becoming too small for him. His curiosity about the world outside of Cavern had so far satisfied him sending spies to tell him what was happening out there. They told of the keepers of the tree of songs and strangers, the Andori, who had fled the slave country and were now settling in Rietland. Any information was precious to him, for he was always anxious to increase the prosperity of the shield gnomes. He was also the one who ordered the construction of the market bridge in order to be able to trade with the people in the Rietland from now on.

But his curiosity knew no measure and now he had decided to leave Cavern and explore Andor and then even the Hadrian Sea. It is not known how the prince came up with this idea. Maybe a traveling merchant had told him about the sea. But it is certain that Hallwort one day began to speak of the Misty Islands, the Tars and wizards of Hadria, the sea-born and the flame-swords.

Hallwort knew he broke the laws of the shield gnomes with his departure, but he did not care. He put the regency into the hands of his son, the young Hallgard, for the time of his absence. And this also caused a lot of trouble among the dwarves, because Hallgard was no less impulsive than his father, but also not yet 80 years old and thus a too young dwarf to bow before him the knee.

When Hallwort walked into the armory on that morning mentioned above and put on the finely crafted mail shirt, the gold breastplate, and put on the large square helmet, he noticed a sign in the corner. The prince took him up and looked at the rich ornaments and thought of Nehal, the dragon and Kreatok, the master smith of the shield dwarves, who once together pursued the blacksmithing and created the four mighty shields. This was the silver shield and the prince laughed. "This useless thing! Haha."

In fact, this shield had been a disappointment to all the dwarfs. Previously, Nehal and Kreatok had crafted the Star Shield, one of the most significant of the four. He was able to stop evil events and change fate for the better. Shortly thereafter, the brother shield, also a powerful shield. This allowed his wearer to accept the powers of another dwarf or transfer his own to another brother. This way the dwarfs could protect each other over long distances.

After these two wonderful shields were created, the expectation was great at the shield dwarves. What would be the next shield that sprang from Nehal's glowing butt and Kreatok's anvil? What protection would he take? Finest silver and gold were left to the two for their next works. And soon they had another sign made.
He was light and beautifully decorated. The torchlight of the great hall lit up silver when the dwarfs first saw him. But as it soon turned out, this shield had no special power. Many suspected already Kreatok and Nehal had lost their powers in the blacksmithing.

But these worries soon proved unfounded, for the master blacksmith and the dragon made another and last shield. His abilities made all doubts fade. Whether the war that soon ensued between Zwegen and Drachen also aroused because of him, is uncertain, but by no means unlikely.

Anyway, all the dwarfs praised the skills of Kreatok and Nehal and the shield that revealed no abilities was then dismissed as a slip-up and soon almost forgotten. When a dwarf remembered him, he was sometimes called the silver shield, sometimes the silent shield but mostly the useless shield.

And so it comes as little wonder that long after that, when the other shields had already been lost in the wars against dragons and creatures, the useless Silver Shield was still in the possession of the Lord of Cavern.



Now Hallwort stroked the fine metal and laughed: "The useless shield for the useless prince. I like that. "He grabbed the shield and left the armory with a mischievous grin on his face.

The next morning, Hallwort, Lord of the Shield Gnomes, left Cavern with four other dwarfs and made his way north to the Hadrian Sea. He was accompanied by Radan, a young but bald-headed dwarf. Radan was astute and the best fighter in Cavern. Hallwort was glad to have Radan at his side. Also Gurd, a cousin of the prince and two dwarves from the deep mines accompanied him.

Little is known about his journey through the Rietland. But when Hallwort, Radan, Gurd, and the other dwarves reached the shore of Andor and found a ship that would carry them north, they experienced something that they would soon forget.



The ship was an old Handelskogge, manufactured in Werft home, the largest Warenumschlagplatz in the north. Her captain was a skinny, sinewy man named Jari Dorr. His face was narrow and his eyes were a cold blue. He watched the sign carefully as the dwarves went on board and Radan, the young baldheaded dwarf, did not like the look at all.

"That's not for you, Seeratte," he snapped at the captain. "We paid you good gold, now take us where my prince orders." The man smiled: "Sorry, dwarf, I thought for a moment, this could be one of the mighty four shields. I've heard a lot about it and well, my eyes fell on it and ... "" Keep your eyes and above all your fingers with you, "Radan replied angrily.
"This shield is actually one of the four powerful ones. It's the sign of doom, "he lied. He distrusted Jari Dorr and wanted to scare him a bit. "If someone touches him who is not a shield dwarf, the lightning kills him. Got it ?! "The captain made a defensive gesture and disappeared silently below deck. "Well, then," Radan said. "He understood that!"

A light south wind blew the sails and a short time later the cog left the coast of Andor.

Prince Hallwort stood for the first time in his life on the bow fortress of a ship and enjoyed the rough wind that blew into his face. Gurd was also happy about the wonderful view and the sea that lay at their feet. Radan and the other dwarves, however, remained below deck most of the time and soon became seasick.

On the third day of their journey, something happened that changed everything. The ship had seized a powerful jolt and Radan had fallen from his bunk. He struggled to get up and heard loud cries on the deck. Immediately he rushed out and saw the crew in high excitement. Radan looked at the water and saw sharp-edged cliffs rising from the churning sea. Captain Dorr shouted over the roaring wind to his helmsman to turn the ship over.

Hallwort and Gurd were still in the front of the ship, trying hard not to go overboard. Then finally it seemed as if the ship had changed the course in time. The cliffs remained on the starboard side and Radan breathed. But only a heartbeat later, he recognized more cliffs directly ahead, where there had not been any. "Beware of cliffs!" He shouted. But Captain Dorr shook his head. "These are not cliffs." "What?" Radan shouted. But now he saw it himself. The rocks grew larger and continued to rise out of the water.

"These are Arrogs!" Roared the captain. "To the weapons men. Occupy the Ballista ". And even before Radan knew exactly what was happening to him, one of the rocks rose even farther out of the sea. And then two yellow-hot eyes looked at him. Radan had never seen such a creature before. The skin was rough and stony, with shells and seaweed hanging from it.

The blow of a massive stone claw shattered the foremast and tore half of the bow fortress apart. Spray sprayed and the ship tilted to the side. When it flung back a moment later, Radan saw a sailor flying through the air as if pulled by invisible strings. And then the body disappeared in a black mouth reinforced with big yellow fangs. Another Arrog had appeared on port. Behind Radan, the figure-eight ballist was buzzing. A big steel arrow swept over his head and barely missed the beast. This took out now also and another heavy blow shook the ship. Wood burst and in the confusion Radan suddenly saw Hallwort, who was still clinging to a rope. But with the other hand held something that Radan could not immediately recognize. Then the sky darkened. The prince had his arm with the silver shield stretched up on it. The shield now shines brightly in the surrounding darkness like a star in the sky. The wind lifted and big waves whipped across the stone grimaces of the Arrogs.



The remaining sail inflated as if it wanted to burst and the ship shot ahead. Radan was ripped off its feet by the force. He heard the Arrogs roar and tried to stand up. But he did not succeed. Soon after, the roar had died away and no sound except the moan of the rigging and the howl of the wind and the massive waves crashing against the bow could be heard.

Radan lost consciousness. When he woke up later he had no idea how long this condition had resisted.

It was still raining, thunder filled the air and the sky was lead gray. But the storm had shrunk to a strong south wind. As he sat up, he saw the destroyed ship. Gurd helped him get up and as Radan looked into the distance, he saw an island not far from the ship. She was surrounded by thick fog.
"Are you okay?" Gurd asked. "Yes," Radan replied. "And the prince," he asked. "Oh, I believe," Gurd replied, "Hallwort is the luckiest dwarf on earth. He is paying the captain for our crossing. We have reached one of the Misty Islands and Hallwort wants to explore it today. You know how he ... "

Then, suddenly, a terrible scream interrupted her. Both dwarves jumped up and then they saw Hallwort staggering out of the cabin. With both hands he pressed a large bleeding wound to his neck. Then Captain Dorr jumped out. In one hand he wore a blood-smeared short sword and in the other the silver shield, or Sturmschild, as everyone called him on board. Some of his men looked confused, but he ran swiftly past them and jumped on one of the moored barrels. "Men, you will not forget this day! This is the day we all became rich men! "A murmur went through the crew, and many just now took their eyes off the panting dwarf prince. "This shield is our reward men!" Shouted Dorr. "With lousy gold, these weights wanted to save us, but see, I've conquered the storm shield for us!"

Radan took his ax off his back. In the corner of his eye, he saw the two dwarves from the deep mines behind, who also took out their weapons. Gurd allerdgings rushed to his bleeding cousin.

"And you gnomes," Jari Dorr continued, turning to Radan, "if you do not want to end up like your lord, I advise you to leave my ship now. We are too many for you. "Thunder sounded and Jari Dor screamed to be heard. "Swim ashore, dwarven pack or run away trying!"

At these words he raised the shield and for a moment Radan thought he was releasing his powers as well. But this time, it was not a glow that surrounded the shield. Instead, he suddenly blazed in a blaze of light. From the clouds overhead a lightning flashed and hit the shield. Jari Dorr was blown out of the air and fell directly at his feet. His twitching body was already black and charred.

The sailors froze as they looked at their captain and the shield lying intact next to him. Then her rigidity dissolved. One of them, a grim-looking graybeard, said, "He's gone." But another passed the corpse and stepped in front of Gurd and Hallwort. Then he tore a strip of cloth from his tunic and handed it to Gurd to feed the prince's wound. Another picked up the shield and handed it to Radan.

This was the end of Captain Dorr and, unfortunately, that of the Prince. When Gurd stopped trying to stop the bleeding, Hallwort smiled at him and asked to bury him here in the north. He loved the salty sea air and never was so happy as here. And so it happened. The dwarfs went ashore, buried the prince not far from the coast, and soon they set up a first camp. Gurd took command. Radan remained on board. He should return home and

report on Hallwort and, of course, the storm shield. He did not trust the team but one of the dwarves had to return to Cavern. Radan did not take a second to sleep and never let go of the ax before he had land under his feet again. The storm shield, however, remained with Gurd in the north.

After about a month, Radan reached outwardly undamaged Cavern. But he had taken another wound, because a deep mistrust of all people had drawn him. And this wound would take years to heal. Hallgard, too, was infected by this distrust when he heard Radan's report. But many of the other shield gnomes felt the same longing that Lord Hallwort had felt. There was a spirit of optimism in the air and in the following years many shield gnomes set out to follow Hallwort's role model.

Gurd had dug first tunnels and found large deposits of ore, gold and, above all, silver. With the reinforcement of other shield dwarves from Cavern Silberhall arose on Silberberg, the northernmost dwarf kingdom. Whether the dwarves living there called the silver dwarves in later years due to the large occurrence of silver or because of the original name of the shield, is not known. And if the storm shield is still kept there, nobody knows who did not dare "The Journey to the North".

THE LAST OF FOUR SHIELDS: THE FIRE SHIELD



It was one evening in March when the few Andori who had not been kidnapped by the Krahdern met in Andor's tavern to celebrate the 3-year existence of the economy. Mart, the dwarf was on behalf of Prince Krams here at the Andori to mobilize all forces. Had the mighty star shield and the brother shield fallen into the hands of the Krahder? Maybe. And though the storm shield might be far to the north, there was one last shield left. To find him, Mart told Andori his dark story ...

AT THE RIETBURG



Finally, the second scout returned. WIRANO!

On a quiet evening in the tavern to drunken troll he told of the way to Rietburg:

Wirano: "Shortly after the meeting broke up, I made my way to the Rietburg. As soon as I left the tavern I turned north. That same night I reached the free market. The stalls and stalls were spooky empty.

Then he told more about the Krahders and their intentions:
"Andori caught in their claws were stunned and trapped. In their land in Krahd, they would serve as slaves until their bodies were consumed. And then, rumor had it, the Krahders summoned their witchcraft and turned people into skeletons that served them until the bones crumbled to dust. Just the thought of it made me shudder. "

When I recognized the Old Fortress Tower on a nearby hill, I knew that I would soon reach my destination. I squatted in the tall grass to take a sip from my drinking tube. When I straightened up, I saw the Rietburg. And dozens of skeletons. A huge krahder in the middle of them. I could not get any closer to details and I'd almost be discovered. I hastily hurried back to the tavern. "

THE SECRET OF THE BROTHERS



According to the sea, the spray of the Hadrian Sea surfed to the coast of the Vigorous Forest. A small hut stood gray and inconspicuous at the edge of the forest. Barely audible above the sound of the waves, there was a soft moan from inside the cabin. The man lying in the hut looked awful. Cuts and scratches furrowed his face with his shaggy beard. Dried blood stuck to his hair. Only the slight lifting and lowering of his chest and the unrhythmic moaning were the only signs that betrayed that he was still alive. He looked as if he had been in a fight or had been attacked by a wild animal. No doubt: something terrible must have happened to him. And this "something" was himself.

The tide flowed around the knuckles of two tall men talking softly near the cabin. One of them was soaking wet and shivering in the cold north wind.

"The cog is destroyed. Many were killed. Humans have a new leader. It's one of those bastards who hunted us. "

"Calm down, brother. Come with me to my hut. Get warm, "replied the other, who was dressed in a long brown cloak. His, as well as the skin of his counterpart, shimmered bluish in the moonless night.

"No. I'm leaving again. I have to gather my strength. Me, I, ... ", the man stared at the rivet and branches covered hut of his brother. "The man I brought you. He will help you complete the work. "

"To complete the work? He looks like he will not even survive the night. If I can not manage his wounds, he will not help at all. "

"Stop playing games, Leander!" Hissed the dripping wet. "You have the gift of foresight. You know if he survives this night. "

Leander cocked his head. He had been the younger of the two but always the wiser and more patient. His brother left early at home. Full of energy and an indescribable greed for fame. And he deserved it too - a dark glory. Leander, on the other hand, had stayed home. Had read and learned a little the art of healing. Then he had developed an interest in languages. First he learned the surrounding countries, then one day the most difficult language of all, the future. It was a form of dark magic that enabled him to see what was not, but is yet to come. But as always, Dark Magic took its toll. As Leander's abilities increased, so did his eyes diminish for now and then until their light went out. Now he could see far ahead and yet he recognized his brother, who stood directly in front of him, only by his voice. And had he seen how emaciated Callem was, he might have answered in a different tone. Instead, he exclaimed, "That's not so easy, you fool! To penetrate the shadows of the present to recognize and interpret the light of the future is no small matter. "

Callem grabbed his younger brother hard by the shoulders. "He's a beast, do not you understand? A skin converter! He will destroy the heroes of Andor. With your help! Brothers! If they feel safe, you will destroy them at their castle, in their camp or wherever! "

Callem's voice carried far over the sea and the beach and Leander admonished him to be quiet.

"Enough now. I share your hatred for the heroes of Andor. I am your brother and your pain is mine as if it were my own. I will try to implement your plan and ... "

Suddenly, while Leander spoke, a small gap opened in the darkness of his being and the light of the near future dazzled him. A vision! Then, as if his seer-eyes had to gradually get used to the brightness, he recognized patterns of approaching figures.

"You have to go, right now. Providence is with us. The wolf, the damn King Wolf, is on the way here. He and another strange creature. The wolf is looking for your friend. He is looking for allies. I see it very clearly - go on brother now. Rest assured, I will put your work into action. I'll smuggle the beast under the unsuspecting sheep and I'll make sure he'll take your revenge. "

"Very good. Yes, brother. "Callem gasped with excitement. "And accompany her, become her friend and if you least expect it, stand against her. And let them know that it was Callem, the one they believed defeated, that sealed their fate. "

Then Callem left his brother. He supplied the wounds of the skinwalker named Drukil.

In the gray light of the first morning, the last tree trunks of the edge of the forest looked as black as the bars of a cage as Lonas the Wolf and Forn the Half-Crate passed them.

The wolf went ahead. He knew whom he was looking for, because finding more of the heroes was the task Chada had given him. Forn, the halfskral, hardly less fast on the legs than the wolf, had already been chosen to be the Andori's entourage. Likewise Darh, the summoner. Finally a small hut at the edge of the forest came into sight.

As the story goes on, whether Drukil is actually dooming his new comrades will be revealed as you play the legends of Andor with the Dark Heroes! Have lots of fun with it!

